

DECODED

THE WESTMINSTER SYMBOLS FIELD GUIDE

*The full key to the carvings, plaques,
and mason's marks the protagonist uses
on page 184.*



HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

READING A WALL, ONE MARK AT A TIME

Three classes of mark recur across Westminster. A mason's mark is small (a thumbnail to a palm), scratched into worked stone, and identifies the cutter rather than the building. An ecclesiastical carving is larger, decorative, and meaningful: foliate heads, angels, beasts. A heraldic device is the loudest of the three — a shield, a portcullis, a crown — and dates a building more precisely than the others. The protagonist carries three pieces of kit: a hand lens, a folding scale, and a notebook with a ruled grid. Bring the same, or close to it.

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§3 MASON'S MARKS

MASON'S MARKS

M-1



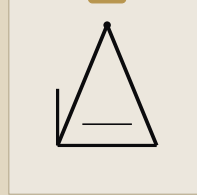
BRASS PLAQUE, BY
ROYAL
APPOINTMENT 1898 /
47

LAMP POST NE OF
TRAFALGAR SQ · TQ
30050 80450

Royal Warrant
lamp-maker's stamp; the
number is the warrant
index.

Novel: p. 184

M-2



COMPASS-AND-SQU
ARE

WESTMINSTER HALL,
BUTTRESS 7, N FACE · TQ
30190 79550

Mason's mark, 14th c.;
same hand as the mark in
The Westminster Arms.

Novel: p. 184

M-3

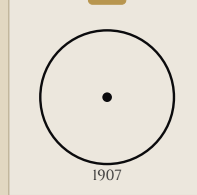


DOUBLE V (VV)
DOOR LINTEL, 12 COWLEY
STREET · TQ30310 79410

Marian apotropaic mark
— protection from
witches.

Novel: p. 190

M-4



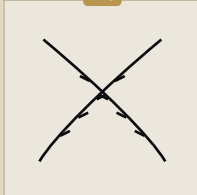
SCRIBED CIRCLE
WITH CENTRAL DOT

PAVEMENT EDGE,
STOREY'S GATE · TQ
30000 79620

Surveyor's benchmark,
1907.

Novel: p. 193

M-5



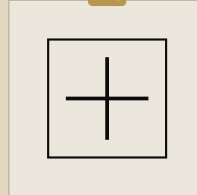
CROSSED QUILLS

BOOKSHOP STEP, 14
GREAT SMITH ST · TQ
30050 79430

Stationer's guild mark,
post-1605.

Novel: p. 198

M-6



SCRATCHED
CROSS-AND-SQUARE

STONE BOLLARD,
WHITEHALL PLACE · TQ
30240 80020

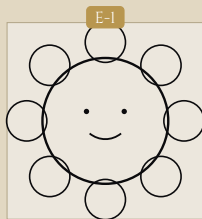
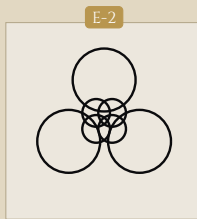
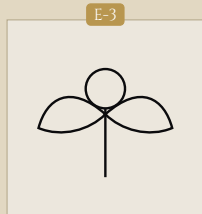
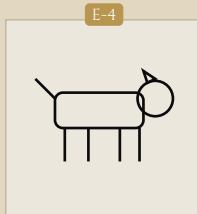
Disputed.

Novel: p. 201

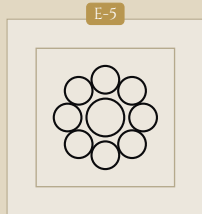
§4 ECCLESIASTICAL CARVINGS

ECCLESIASTICAL CARVINGS

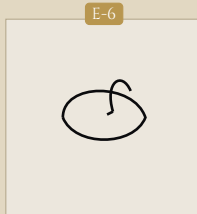
GREEN MAN

WESTMINSTER ABBEY,
NORTH DOOR HEADFoliage face;
pre-Christian motif
retained as roof boss.*Novel: p. 206*TREFOIL-AND-ROSE
BOSSCHAPTER HOUSE VAULT,
CENTRAL BOSS13th-century. Trefoil =
Trinity; rose = Marian
devotion.*Novel: p. 208*LITLINGTON-ERA
ANGELSOUTH TRANSEPT, WEST
WALL, SPRINGING POINTLate 14th c.; carved
during the abbacy of
Nicholas Litlington.*Novel: p. 218*UNIDENTIFIED
BEASTHENRY VII'S LADY
CHAPEL, EXTERIOR
CORNICE (NE CORNER)Quadrupedal; neither
lion nor griffin. Locally
called "the abbot's dog".*Novel: p. 223*

MARIGOLD TILE

PYX CHAMBER FLOOR,
NW CORNER13th-c. Westminster tile;
one of the few originals
surviving in situ.*Novel: p. 204*

WORN PELICAN

SOUTH PORCH,
LABEL-STOP ABOVE THE
INNER ARCHPelican-in-piety;
Eucharistic motif. Beak
almost lost to
weathering.*Novel: p. 229*

§5 HERALDIC DEVICES

HERALDIC DEVICES

**ROYAL ARMS
(STUART)**

H-1

BANQUETING HOUSE
PEDIMENT · TQ30210
80020

Four quarters; Scottish
lion in q.2. Hanoverian
arms drop it after 1714.

Novel: p. 166

**WESTMINSTER
PORTCULLIS**

H-2

PARLIAMENT GATE, ST
STEPHEN'S ENTRANCE

Tudor badge; symbol of
the Palace of
Westminster since the
16th c.

Novel: p. 150

**CITY OF
WESTMINSTER
SCALLOP**

H-3

CITY LAMP POSTS,
VICTORIA STREET SIDE

Scallop shell of St James;
civic arms granted 1601.

Novel: p. 173

MITRE-AND-KEYS

H-4

ABBNEY PRECINCT,
GATEWAY TO DEAN'S
YARD

Mitre over crossed keys:
arms of the Royal
Peculiar.

Novel: p. 207

**ORDER OF THE BATH
STAR**

H-5

HENRY VII'S LADY
CHAPEL, CHOIR STALLS

Eight-pointed star;
Knights of the Bath
installed here since 1725.

Novel: p. 224

GARTER MOTTO

H-6

FOREIGN OFFICE, KING
CHARLES ST FACADE · TQ
30150 79770

HONI SOIT QUI MAL
Y PENSE. Garter ribbon
arching over the door.

Novel: p. 188

THE PROTAGONIST'S CIPHER

NUMBERED PLAQUES AND DATES

On page 184 of the novel the protagonist combines two numbers carved on a single plaque into a single index into the master list of pubs in File 01. The rule is simple. Reduce the date to a two-digit digit-sum; combine with the warrant number to make a three-digit page key. Worked example follows.

WORKED EXAMPLE — M-1, TRAFALGAR SQUARE

Step 1. Read the date. 1898.

Step 2. Sum the digits. $1 + 8 + 9 + 8 = 26$.

Step 3. Read the warrant number. 47.

Step 4. Apply the rule: $\text{page} = (\text{warrant} \times 4) - (\text{digit-sum} \times 2 \div 13)$.

Step 5. Substitute: $(47 \times 4) - (26 \times 2 \div 13) = 188 - 4 = 184$.

Step 6. Turn to page 184 of the novel.

Try it on M-3 (Cowley Street) and M-5 (Great Smith Street). The grid below is for your own findings: date, warrant number, result, the page where you found it confirmed.

DATE	NUMBER	PAGE	NOTES

THE WALK

NINETY MINUTES, SIX MARKS, ONE PINT AT THE END

Start: north-east corner of Trafalgar Square, lamp post nearest the National Gallery steps.

End: The Cask & Glass, 39–41 Palace Street, SW1E 5HN.

Distance: 2.4 miles. Time: 90 minutes at observing pace.

01 M-1 · TRAFALGAR SQUARE

Look for: Look for: the brass plaque on the lamp post nearest the National Gallery steps. 1898 / 47.

Log it: Log it: write down the warrant number and the date side by side.

02 M-2 · WESTMINSTER HALL, BUTTRESS 7

Look for: Look for: a compass-and-square scratched into the north face, knee height.

Log it: Log it: rub a piece of soft graphite across the back of your page to bring it up.

03 E-5 · PYX CHAMBER, MARIGOLD TILE (ABBEY TICKET REQUIRED)

Look for: Look for: the 8-petal tile, NW corner of the chamber floor.

Log it: Log it: note the position relative to the door.

04 M-3 · COWLEY STREET, NO. 12

Look for: Look for: the double V on the lintel — a Marian apotropaic mark, west of the keystone.

Log it: Log it: angle of incised line, depth (mm).

05 H-6 · FOREIGN OFFICE, KING CHARLES STREET

Look for: Look for: HONI SOIT QUI MAL Y PENSE running around the Garter above the entrance.

Log it: Log it: count the letters that are still legible.

06 M-5 · 14 GREAT SMITH STREET

Look for: Look for: crossed quills, stationer's mark, cut into the step.

Log it: Log it: pub-and-page from the cipher (Step 5 only).

If you finish this walk and your notebook is fuller than the guide, the guide has done its job.



*If you find a symbol not in this guide,
write to the author.*

The next edition belongs to its finders.

FILE 03 / 04 · READER COPY